

The Glorious King of Tantras, Blazing Wisdom

Śrī Jñāna Jvāla Tantra Rāja · Toh 394 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་ཡ་ཤེས་འབར་བའི་རྒྱ་ཀླིང་པོ།

Toh 394 in the Kangyur is a tantric scripture known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Jñāna Jvāla Tantra Rāja and in Tibetan as the Dpal ye shes 'bar ba'i rgyud kyi rgyal po, rendered in English as The Glorious King of Tantras, Blazing Wisdom. It belongs to the class of Buddhist tantric literature and concerns the nature of non-dual wisdom, great bliss, and self-awareness, framed as a dialogue in which a questioner addresses the Buddha and receives teachings from a figure identified as the Great Terrifier. The text opens with verses of wonder and inquiry about the tantra itself, before unfolding its esoteric content around themes of maṇḍala, self-consecration, and the direct realization of reality. As a tantra associated with Samantabhadra and situated among the highest teachings of the Kangyur, it represents the kind of condensed, symbolically rich scripture characteristic of the tantric collections of that canon.

In the language of India: Śrī Jñāna Jvāla Tantra Rāja. In the language of Tibet: The Glorious King of Tantras, Blazing Wisdom. Homage to the Glorious Samantabhadra.

Alas, O Buddha, O Buddha!

What is this wondrous and astonishing tantra?

What is it, and who is its king?

What is the wisdom, and what is the blazing?

What is the glory? Speak it to me.

The Great Terrifier replied:

The glory is non-dual wisdom,

arisen from the taste of non-dual great bliss.

It is self-awareness, free from the extremes of subject and object.

The great wisdom that unties the manifold knot,

whose navel is self-consecration,

and whose secret is the maṇḍala wheel.

Like the ūṛṇā hair-mark between the brows,

it abides briefly and then extends at length.

Of this very reality there are three: the direct, the separating, and the expanding.

Regarding first the direct form,
there are three measures of arousal.
With the three gateways endowed with three qualities,
it will definitely emerge four finger-breadths outward.
For the middling, two finger-breadths; for the last,
it emerges by the measure of one finger and a barleycorn's breadth.
Whether thick or thin, from another's birth it is merely slender.
At first it abides in the very face of the bird.
Liberation: two finger-breadths, four sense bases,
the sixteen emptinesses, the eighteen elements,
twenty at the navel, twenty-five —
this is what abides in the heart.

By arousing all things such as medicinal substances,
one should begin the practice of the direct.

Offering the coarse binding of Vairocana's body,
offering the back-support and making offerings,
offering the seat-throne and offering the ritual bath,
offering medicinal offerings and offering the fire offering,
and then making the tactile offering —
whether at the tip of the conventional tongue
or at the tip of the wrathful finger,
an ambrosia pill well prepared:
thus the skilled one makes the tactile offering.
Direct awareness is certain to arise.
With the offering of great bliss,
offering to the three realms is certain.

Silk or fine cloth of four finger-breadths measure,
a belt should be offered at the waist.
To the right and left of the emanation,
a back-support of cotton and so forth should be offered.
The type of wood is made concordant,
fitting with the nature of the one who is thick or thin.

With pure medicine and offering substances that possess oil
and do not generate irritation,
make offerings along the path of Vairocana.
Having bathed with fragrant water,

through bathing, make the bodily offering.
With powder of medicine and oil
make offerings pure at the two gateways.
With a fire that is very warm,
make offerings to the fire of the inner heat.
Equal to the measure of the waist, the kāṭika:
make the offering by establishing the seat-throne.
By this, arousal is certain.

Then as for the expanding —
the rest is similar to the foregoing:
all outer and inner signs of desire
are activities that cause expansion.
When the three practices of expanding have been performed,
it is like a lotus flower.

Then the sequence of separating as well
is in common with what was stated above.
Even by moving the tip of the tongue three times,
it will certainly open.

Those three are of the nature of fire.
The condition that causes fire to blaze
is said to be the wind itself;
through that condition, fire itself is said to blaze.

Moreover, regarding the different types of condition,
the vital wind is to be blocked at the central channel.
Having offered vase-breathing with no resting of the feet,
it is driven out forcefully through the nine gates.
The fatigue of the body is equalised,
and when the practice is complete, it becomes the condition for bliss.

From bliss arises Vajradhara;
by bliss, bliss is accomplished.
When the cause is bliss, the fruit is bliss.
Among causes this is supreme;
among fruits this is supreme.

Then, that which becomes the condition for bliss:
blocking existence, blocking the wind.

From place to place, holding the support.
By extending the right, Romaṇī is blocked —
the hero on the right, the ḍākinī on the left.
By extending the left, Rkyaṇ-ma it is,
grasped as the all-trembling earth-quaking one.
Likewise, by rounding it, the central channel is grasped.
The distinctions among all of these:
the hero holds the right, and the other holds the left.

Likewise, this is to be applied to all.
Furthermore, as for the distinctions in grasping:
through the ninefold path of the tubular bell-drum,
the wind-current is drawn outward by suction.
If the hands and feet are firmly contracted,
there is no doubt that grasping is accomplished.
It is taught that the hero and the ḍākinī, both together,
are to perform this in common.

The karmic wind of Vairocana,
and likewise all the winds of the eightfold path —
if these are bound from the very first,
there is no doubt that grasping is accomplished.
This is the intimate instruction on the distinctions of binding.
If the activity disperses and moves outward,
there is no doubt that grasping fails.

Visualizing the syllable KṢAḤ in the three places,
and drawing upward with the third breath,
grasping is accomplished even by drawing upward toward the navel.
This belongs to the supreme individual.

At that very crown of beauty,
pressing upward and pressing downward,
straight, to the right and left, by forceful means —
one forceful technique is the pin of the hip-joint:
pressing down with the wrathful, the stout one.
If this is not received from the mouth of a guru,
all four diseases of the body arise everywhere.
Blockage of water, swelling at the water-gate, and so forth —

twenty types of disease in the lower body arise.
Furthermore, the twelve forceful techniques
are to be known from the mouth of a guru.

In order to please the guru,
with body, life, and all one's resources,
offer with maṇḍala throughout the three times.
More precious than offering body and life
is that supreme intimate instruction.
Therefore keep the forceful techniques well concealed.
The intimate instruction flows like the current of a river;
know it as that very stream flowing in the continuum.
The King proclaims the teaching of the profound meaning.

To Vajravārāhī and the rest,
this secret of secrets, wondrous and extraordinary —
it is entrusted to you; commit it to the sacred bond.
If it is spread to all, the samaya is broken.

Alas! With regard to the meaning of this tantra,
the assembled heroes and ḍākinīs
dwelling in the world-realms of the ten directions
all arise in great wonder,
rejoicing and delighted, they cheer in jubilation.

The Secret Greater Than the Secret of the Ḍākinīs, from the King of Tantras of
the Blazing Glorious Gnosis, is complete.

The yoga of the isle of Siṃhala —

Translator's Notes

- The passage is the opening of a Vajrayāna tantra (the Śrī Jñāna Jvāla Tantra Rāja). The speaker identified as "the Great Terrifier" is most likely Mahābhairava or Vajrabhairava, a wrathful tantric deity; this epithet is standard for the respondent-deity in such dialogue-format tantras.

The phrase rendered "face of the bird" likely refers to a tantric anatomical or symbolic term for a specific channel-point or cakra; the exact referent is uncertain without access to a commentary tradition specific to this tantra.

The term "Rkyaṅ-ma" is the Tibetan name for the left channel (Skt. lalanā or iḍā); I have left it in transliterated form at first occurrence since the context makes the channel identification clear from the surrounding terms (Romaṇī for the right channel, rasanā; central channel for the

central, avadhūtī). "Romaṇī" is a known Vajrayāna name for the right channel.

"Kāṭika" is a Sanskrit loan-word retained in the Tibetan; it likely refers to a specific seat or bodily lock (bandha) at the waist level. Its precise ritual referent is uncertain without further commentary.

The sections on "direct, separating, and expanding" along with finger-breadth measurements and anatomical enumerations clearly belong to the completion-stage (Skt. sampannakrama) physiological instructions of advanced anuttarayoga tantra practice, involving the subtle body, channels, and bliss.

- The text ends mid-phrase with "the yoga of the isle of Siṃhala" (Siṃhaladvīpa, i.e. Sri Lanka), which appears to be a colophon fragment indicating the origin or transmission lineage of the text; the passage breaks off here and whatever followed is not included in this excerpt.

The "tubular bell-drum" rendering for dril-can bu-gu dgu-lam is interpretive: the compound most likely refers to a hollow tube with nine passages, a technical tantric anatomical metaphor for the channels; the translation attempts to preserve the image without over-specifying.

The "pin of the hip-joint" renders ka-ti'i gzer, a term for a specific forceful technique (bcan-thabs) involving the hip-joint or sacral region; this is a rare tantric physiological term and the exact practice is left deliberately allusive per the text's own injunction of secrecy.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.